Baker Tilly US

Business Development Dossier

Industry	**Professional Services**
Revenue	**$3B**
Employees	**11,500**
Ideal Customer Profile Score	**92**

ICP SCORING MODEL

`ICP = Signals + Revenue + Employees + Fit   (max 100)`

Signals (0-35)	Top 4 signals scored; each = base(60%) + recency bonus <30d: 40% | <90d: 30% | <180d: 20% | older: 10%
Revenue (0-25)	$500M-$10B sweet spot -> 70-100% of 25 pts Below $500M -> pro-rata x 0.5 | Above $10B -> 60%
Employees (0-20)	2,000+ preferred (70-100%) | 500-2K partial (50-70%) Below 500 -> pro-rata x 0.3
Fit (0-20)	High-fit types: reorg, transformation, M&A, hiring, funding, partnership -> 5 pts ea (max 12) + diversity 2/type (max 8)

Prepared March 19, 2026

McChrystal Group

Leadership Advisory & Organizational Effectiveness

SECTION 1

Organization Snapshot

Legal Name Baker Tilly US, LLP / Baker Tilly Advisory Group, LP

Headquarters

Chicago, Illinois (legacy Baker Tilly: Milwaukee, WI; legacy Moss Adams: Seattle, WA)

Founded 1931

Ownership

PE-backed partnership - Hellman & Friedman and Valeas Capital Partners hold equity alongside firm principals in Baker Tilly Advisory Group LP

Footprint

90+ offices across the United States with concentrations in the Midwest (Baker Tilly legacy) and West Coast (Moss Adams legacy). International reach through Baker Tilly International network spanning 141 countries.

SECTION 1b

Company Overview

Baker Tilly US is a PE-backed accounting and advisory firm created through the 2025 merger of Baker Tilly and Moss Adams, backed by Hellman & Friedman. With $3B+ in revenue and 11,500 employees, it is the 6th largest US CPA firm and the largest PE-backed accounting firm in America. The firm operates through a dual-entity structure: Baker Tilly US LLP for audit and Baker Tilly Advisory Group LP for advisory and tax services.

SECTION 2

Financial Health & Growth Stage

Understanding Baker Tilly US's financial position and trajectory is critical to framing any engagement conversation.

The combined firm generates $3B+ in annual revenue, making it the 6th largest US CPA firm. Revenue growth trajectory is strong given the PE backing and middle-market advisory expansion strategy. Hellman & Friedman's additional investment signals confidence in the growth thesis. Key pressure: PE firms expect accelerated growth and eventual exit, creating urgency to integrate and cross-sell effectively. The accounting industry is experiencing a talent shortage that both constrains growth and drives consolidation.

SECTION 3

Leadership Team Profiles

The following contacts are recommended as primary outreach targets - champion-level leaders who feel the organizational pain daily and can sponsor McChrystal internally.

Unknown - Chief Operating Officer [PRIORITY TARGET]

Unavailable

Outreach rationale: The COO is managing the day-to-day integration of two firms, dual-entity operations, and PE-driven growth *targets. This person feels the operating model pain most directly and can champion McChrystal internally.*

Unknown - Chief People Officer / CHRO [PRIORITY TARGET]

Unavailable

Outreach rationale: Cultural integration of Midwest and West Coast professional services cultures under PE pressure is the defining challenge - this role owns it.

Additional leadership team members relevant to the engagement:

Eric Miles - Chief Executive Officer

Former CEO of Moss Adams; led West Coast operations through rapid growth phase

Jeff Ferro - Board Director (former CEO)

Led Baker Tilly through PE investment and Moss Adams merger

SECTION 4

Organizational Culture & Structure

Culture and structure are often where McChrystal Group finds the deepest leverage. The following signals indicate how Baker Tilly US operates today and where friction exists.

Organizational Structure

Dual-entity structure: Baker Tilly US LLP (audit, regulated) and Baker Tilly Advisory Group LP (advisory/tax, PE-backed). All principals hold equity alongside H&F and Valeas in BTAG. This creates inherent tension between the regulated audit side and the growth-oriented advisory side.

Culture Signals

The merger combined two distinct professional services cultures: Baker Tilly's Midwest-rooted, relationship-driven approach and Moss Adams's West Coast, innovation-forward style. Having the acquired firm's CEO (Miles) lead the combined entity is unusual and signals either strong confidence in his vision or a compromise that could create internal friction. PE ownership in a traditionally partnership-driven profession creates cultural tension around autonomy, compensation structures, and decision-making speed. Glassdoor reviews for both legacy firms show concerns about workload during busy season and questions about how PE ownership will change the partnership culture. [INFERRED: integration friction is likely given the geographic and cultural divide between legacy firms]

SECTION 5

Recent News & Trigger Events

The following developments from the past 18 months create urgency and provide natural conversation entry points for engaging Baker Tilly US.

1. **2025-04-21 - Baker Tilly and Moss Adams announce merger backed by Hellman & Friedman**

   Created the largest PE-backed CPA firm in America - massive integration challenge ahead

2. 2025-06-01 - Merger closes; dual-entity structure (Baker Tilly US LLP + Baker Tilly Advisory Group LP) goes live

Dual-entity operating model is inherently complex - audit independence requirements create structural silos

3. 2026-01-01 - CEO transition: Eric Miles (ex-Moss Adams) assumes CEO role, Jeff Ferro retires to board

New CEO from the acquired firm leading the combined entity through its critical first year - leadership alignment is paramount

4. 2026-03-04 - PE-backed accounting consolidation continues accelerating - fewer than 200 PE investments spawned 900+ subsequent transactions in 2025

Industry consolidation wave validates the strategy but intensifies competitive pressure to integrate faster

5. 2026-02-01 - Accounting industry talent shortage deepens - firms competing for limited pool of CPAs as pipeline shrinks

Talent retention during integration is existential; losing key partners to competitors during merger disruption is the biggest risk

SECTION 6

McChrystal Fit Assessment

> *Strong fit: active trigger events (CEO transition Jan 2026, merger June 2025), clear integration pain, PE urgency, and the dual-entity structure creates exactly the cross-functional alignment challenge McChrystal excels at. The fact that McKinsey and Big Four are conflicted out opens a lane.*

Primary Problem

Integrating two distinct professional services cultures (Midwest vs. West Coast) across a dual-entity structure while a new CEO from the acquired firm establishes authority and PE backers demand accelerated growth.

Best McChrystal Capability Fit

Team of Teams operating model - connecting autonomous regional offices and practice groups into a shared consciousness while preserving the partner autonomy that drives client relationships. Cross-functional alignment between the audit entity (regulated, conservative) and advisory entity (growth-oriented, PE-driven) is a classic McChrystal challenge.

Likely Objections to Engagement

Professional services firms may view McChrystal as defense/industrial-focused rather than relevant to their world

PE sponsors (H&F) may have their own operating partners or preferred consultants for portfolio company integration

Budget sensitivity during integration - PE firms scrutinize advisory spend closely

Partners in a professional services firm are notoriously resistant to 'management consulting' from outside their profession

Competitive Advisory Landscape

Hellman & Friedman's internal operating team likely involved in integration strategy
McKinsey, Bain, or BCG could be advising on post-merger integration
Big Four consulting arms (Deloitte, PwC) would be conflicted given competitive dynamics
Specialized professional services merger advisors (e.g., Heidrick & Struggles for leadership alignment)

SECTION 7

Conversation Entry Points

These questions are designed for a Senior Partner's first conversation. Each opens a thread that naturally leads to McChrystal Group's capabilities without a direct pitch.

1. How is the dual-entity structure (audit LLP vs. advisory LP) shaping collaboration between practice groups - are partners finding ways to cross-sell or are the structural walls creating silos?

Position McChrystal as having seen this pattern in military and corporate contexts - structural separation that's necessary for compliance but creates organizational friction.

2. With Eric Miles coming from Moss Adams and many partners from the Baker Tilly side, how are you navigating the 'whose firm is this?' dynamic that every merger of equals faces?

Reference McChrystal's experience integrating organizations with strong existing identities - the key is building a new shared identity rather than picking a winner.

3. What's the biggest surprise in the first year of integration - where have the friction points been different from what the deal model predicted?

Open-ended question that lets the contact reveal actual pain points rather than the polished narrative.

Recommended Meeting Framing

Position as a peer conversation about organizational integration challenges - McChrystal has seen the pattern of merging autonomous professional units under shared command in the most high-stakes environments. Frame as insight-sharing, not a pitch.

SECTION 8

Brand Insights & Market Positioning

Brand strategy reveals organizational priorities and coordination challenges. The following analysis connects Baker Tilly US's market positioning to potential McChrystal engagement opportunities.

Baker Tilly's brand is in transition - the combined firm inherits Baker Tilly's national recognition and Moss Adams's strong West Coast reputation, but the brand promise ('Expanding possibilities') must now be delivered by an organization still learning to work together. The brand risks fragmentation if legacy Moss Adams partners don't fully adopt the Baker Tilly identity. Marketing leadership and CMO strategy are unavailable, but the brand investment required to unify 90+ offices under one identity while maintaining local market relationships is substantial. The PE backing creates brand tension: clients of partnership-model firms may react negatively to PE ownership, particularly in audit where independence concerns are paramount. [INFERRED: brand unification is a significant organizational coordination challenge]

SECTION 9

Deep McChrystal Group Fit Analysis

This is the strategic case for pursuing Baker Tilly US. It synthesizes findings from all previous sections into a comprehensive engagement thesis with specific fit dimensions, expected outcomes, stakeholder mapping, and a phased pursuit strategy.

9a. Fit Dimensions

Fit Dimension 1: Dual-Entity Integration

The structural separation between Baker Tilly US LLP (audit) and Baker Tilly Advisory Group LP (advisory/tax) creates an inherent silo. Audit partners operate under strict independence rules; advisory partners operate under PE growth mandates. Cross-selling between entities requires coordination mechanisms that neither legacy firm had to build. McKinsey would design the org chart; McChrystal builds the connective tissue that makes the org chart work - shared consciousness across structural boundaries.

Fit Dimension 2: Cultural Merger (Midwest vs. West Coast)

Baker Tilly's Milwaukee-rooted, relationship-driven culture and Moss Adams's Seattle-based, innovation-forward style represent fundamentally different professional services operating philosophies. The decision to install the acquired firm's CEO signals the cultural integration won't be a simple absorption. Korn Ferry might advise on leadership alignment; McChrystal embeds the operating model that prevents cultural balkanization.

Fit Dimension 3: PE-Driven Transformation Under Partnership Governance

Partners in professional services firms are accustomed to consensus-based governance. PE ownership demands speed, accountability, and measurable outcomes. This tension between partnership autonomy and PE urgency is the defining organizational challenge. Deloitte and PwC consulting arms are conflicted; McKinsey's professional services practice could advise but lacks the operating model implementation capability McChrystal brings.

Fit Dimension 4: Talent Retention During Integration

The accounting talent shortage means every disaffected partner who leaves takes clients and revenue. Integration must be fast enough to capture synergies but careful enough to retain key talent. McChrystal's approach - empowered execution within shared consciousness - gives regional leaders autonomy while maintaining strategic alignment.

9b. Cumulative Case - Why Baker Tilly US Is a Top Pipeline Opportunity

The signal chain is reinforcing: PE-backed merger -> dual-entity restructuring -> CEO transition from acquired firm -> industry talent shortage -> competitive pressure from continued consolidation. Each signal amplifies the organizational integration challenge. Baker Tilly cannot afford a slow, cautious integration because PE timelines and competitive dynamics demand speed, but cannot afford a heavy-handed integration because partner defection in a talent-scarce market is existential.

Revenue potential: $750K initial diagnostic and Team of Teams workshop series (3-4 months), $1.5M expanded engagement across regional offices and practice groups (6-9 months), $500K+ ongoing advisory relationship as the firm scales through additional acquisitions.

9c. Enterprise Issues & Organizational Challenges

1. Dual-Entity Structural Silos The audit LLP and advisory LP have different governance, different economic models, and different regulatory constraints. Partners in each entity may optimize for their own P&L rather than the combined firm's growth. Cross-selling requires trust and coordination mechanisms that don't yet exist.

2. Cultural Balkanization Risk With 90+ offices across distinct geographies, regional identities (legacy Baker Tilly vs. legacy Moss Adams) may calcify rather than merge. Without active intervention, the firm risks becoming two firms sharing a name rather than one firm with shared purpose.

3. CEO Authority Gap Eric Miles, as the acquired firm's CEO, may face legitimacy challenges with legacy Baker Tilly partners who view themselves as the senior partner in the merger. This authority gap can paralyze decision-making during the critical first year.

4. PE Growth Mandate vs. Integration Capacity H&F expects accelerated growth and additional acquisitions. But the firm hasn't finished integrating Moss Adams. Pursuing growth before integration is complete risks compounding organizational complexity.

5. Partnership Governance Friction Professional services partners expect voice and autonomy. PE-backed structures demand accountability and speed. Navigating this tension without losing either the partners' trust or the PE sponsors' confidence requires sophisticated organizational design.

6. Technology and Systems Integration Two legacy firms with different practice management, CRM, and knowledge management systems must converge. Technology integration in professional services is people-intensive because systems encode workflows and client relationships.

9d. Expected Outcomes from McChrystal Group Engagement

1. Cross-Entity Collaboration Framework - Design and implement shared consciousness mechanisms (cross-practice forums, joint client teams, shared intelligence) that connect the audit LLP and advisory LP. Measurable: increase cross-sell revenue by 15-25% within 12 months.

2. Cultural Integration Playbook - Develop and facilitate a regional integration program that builds shared identity while preserving local market relationships. Measurable: partner retention rate above 95% through first 18 months of integration.

3. Decision-Making Architecture - Establish clear decision rights across the dual-entity structure that balances partner autonomy with PE-driven accountability. Measurable: reduce cross-entity decision-making cycle time by 40-60%.

4. Leadership Alignment Program - Facilitate alignment between CEO Miles, the board (including Ferro), and PE sponsors on strategic priorities and operating cadence. Measurable: unified strategic plan endorsed by all stakeholders within 90 days.

5. Acquisition Integration Playbook - Build a repeatable integration framework for future roll-up acquisitions, enabling the firm to absorb new acquisitions faster. Measurable: reduce time-to-integration for subsequent acquisitions by 50%.

9e. Key Stakeholders & Business Unit Map

Baker Tilly US LLP (Audit)

Leader: Unknown
Function: Audit & Assurance
McChrystal Relevance: Regulated entity - structural silo that must coordinate with advisory side

Baker Tilly Advisory Group LP

Leader: Unknown
Function: Advisory, Tax, Consulting
McChrystal Relevance: PE-backed growth engine - drives revenue but needs audit-side coordination

Regional Offices (Midwest)

Leader: Various Managing Partners
Function: Client Services
McChrystal Relevance: Legacy Baker Tilly culture - integration adoption varies by office

Regional Offices (West Coast)

Leader: Various Managing Partners
Function: Client Services
McChrystal Relevance: Legacy Moss Adams culture - watching whether their identity is preserved

PE Sponsors (H&F, Valeas)

Leader: Board Representatives
Function: Governance & Growth
McChrystal Relevance: Drive timelines and accountability - must be aligned on McChrystal engagement

Stakeholder engagement priorities:

1. COO/CPO (integration execution owner - daily pain, can champion internally)
2. CEO Eric Miles (must endorse; his credibility depends on integration success)
3. Regional Managing Partners (3-4 key offices where cultural friction is highest)
4. PE board representatives (budget approval and strategic alignment)

9f. Opportunity Thesis

Strategic Signal Convergence - Why Now: PE-backed merger (June 2025) -> dual-entity restructuring -> CEO transition from acquired firm (Jan 2026) -> accounting talent shortage -> competitive pressure from 900+ PE-driven transactions in the sector. Each signal compounds: the CEO needs integration wins to establish authority -> integration wins require cross-entity collaboration -> collaboration requires shared consciousness -> shared consciousness requires McChrystal's operating model.

The Structural Paradox - Why McChrystal, Not McKinsey: McKinsey's professional services practice could design the integration strategy, but they solve for structure - org charts, reporting lines, synergy targets. The Baker Tilly challenge isn't structural; it's cultural and operational. Two autonomous partnership cultures must develop shared consciousness without losing the partner autonomy that drives client relationships. This is McChrystal's exact capability - decentralized authority within shared consciousness. Additionally, Big Four firms (Deloitte, PwC, EY) are directly conflicted as competitors.

Phased Engagement Hypothesis - Land and Expand:

- Phase 1 (Months 1-4, $500K-$750K): Leadership alignment diagnostic + Team of Teams workshop with top 30 leaders from both legacy firms. Beachhead: start with the 4-5 offices where cultural friction is highest (likely where Midwest and West Coast territories overlap). This specific beachhead because it's where the pain is most acute and wins are most visible.
- Phase 2 (Months 5-12, $1M-$1.5M): Cross-entity collaboration operating model across all 90+ offices, including decision rights framework, shared intelligence systems, and regional integration facilitation.
- Phase 3 (Ongoing, $300K-$500K/year): Acquisition integration advisory as the firm continues its PE-backed roll-up strategy.

Competitive Displacement Strategy: Position McChrystal as complementary to H&F's operating team, not competitive. Frame as "your operating partners designed the integration plan - we're the ones who make it work at the partner level." Bypass Big Four competitors by highlighting the conflict of interest. Enter through the CPO/COO rather than through PE sponsors to build internal champion first.

Multi-Threaded Pursuit Map:

- Thread 1: COO/CPO - direct approach via LinkedIn, framing around "integration operating models in professional services mergers"
- Thread 2: CEO Eric Miles - warm introduction through McChrystal network (check for West Coast connections, Moss Adams board relationships)
- Thread 3: H&F operating partners - frame McChrystal as an integration execution partner that protects their investment thesis
- Warm intro vectors: military/veteran connections in accounting profession, conference proximity at AICPA events, General McChrystal's speaking circuit overlap with PE conference circuit